CD PROJEKT RED – SWOT Analysis

Polish AAA game studio (Warsaw) • *The Witcher*, *Cyberpunk 2077*, *Gwent*

Strengths

- Two globally known brands: *The Witcher* and *Cyberpunk*
- Reputation for strong stories, quests and characters
- Large expansions (*Blood and Wine*, *Phantom Liberty*) and long free support
- Own store (GOG) and solid finances from older games
- Free *Witcher 3* remaster (2022) brought back more players on Steam than at launch

Weaknesses

- Damaged trust after the broken *Cyberpunk 2077* launch (2020)
- Very long gaps between games; income depends on 1–2 titles
- History of forced overtime and overpromising
- Loss of own-engine know-how (REDengine) during the switch to Unreal Engine 5

Opportunities

- Netflix series and *Edgerunners* anime bring new fans
- Steady demand for big single-player story RPGs
- New consoles (PS5, Xbox Series, Switch 2) let old games sell again
- Unreal Engine 5 makes hiring easier and allows several projects at once
- Booming physical card games: a *Gwent* TCG with booster packs
- Episodic *Gwent* story campaigns (like *Thronebreaker*) set in the world of *The Witcher 4*; the first episode advertises the main game

Threats

- Players and investors punish broken launches hard
- Rising game budgets and strong RPG rivals (Bethesda, BioWare, Larian, Warhorse)
- Competition for experienced developers
- Delays or tech problems with the new engine and parallel projects
- Small audience for *Gwent* spin-offs: neither *Thronebreaker* nor *Rogue Mage* got a sequel
- Strong card game rivals (*Hearthstone*, *Balatro*, *Slay the Spire*) and big TCGs (*Pokémon*, *Magic*)
- A delay of *The Witcher 4* also delays the campaigns tied to it
- Players may see paid episodes and bonus cards as a cash grab